

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J T 8

♥ K T 8

♦ T 7 5

♣ Q T 5

♠ 7 6 4 2

♥ 7 6 3

♦ 8 6 4

♣ J 9 8



♠ A K 9

♥ Q 9 5

♦ A 9 3 2

♣ A 6 3

♠ 5 3

♥ A J 4 2

♦ K Q J

♣ K 7 4 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♣

1♠

Dbl

All Pass

2♣ by North

SOUTH has 14 points, a doubleton in the opponent's ♠ suit and at least three cards in each of the other suits. This is a normal Takeout Double.

NORTH has a really awful hand. He has just one point and his only 4-card suit is the one the opponents have already bid. He wants nothing more than to pass.

But he cannot pass. Partner's Double said "Bid your best suit.", so he bids 2♣.

Mercifully SOUTH also passes.

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 6 4 3
 ♥ 9 6 3
 ♦ 8 6 2
 ♣ K Q T 6

♠ Q 9 8 5

♥ K Q T 5

♦ A K 3

♣ 4 2



♠ K 2

♥ A 8 4 2

♦ T 7 4

♣ J 9 7 5

♠ A J T 7

♥ J 7

♦ Q J 9 5

♣ A 8 3

With 14 points, ♣ shortage, and support for the other suits NORTH makes a Takeout Double.

SOUTH has 13 points so she bids 2♣. This is an artificial bid, apprising NORTH of SOUTH's opening hand strength, and forcing the partnership to reach the game level.

NORTH suggests ♥s as trumps. SOUTH doesn't like ♥s so she suggests ♠s. NORTH agrees with ♠s and bids game, 4♠.

West	North	East	South
1♣	Dbl	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by South			

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 5 2
 ♥ A J T 8
 ♦ 9 8 4 2
 ♣ Q J 4

♠ A K J 9 8 3

♥ 7

♦ A K J 3

♣ 7 5



♠ T 6
 ♥ K Q 4 3
 ♦ T 7 6
 ♣ K T 9 2

♠ Q 7 4

♥ 9 6 5 2

♦ Q 5

♣ A 8 6 3

EAST's 1♥ opening is passed around to NORTH. He is tempted to overcall 1♠, but with 18 points is a little strong for a mere overcall. Instead, he doubles.

With 8 points SOUTH is not strong enough to jump. She bids 2♣.

NORTH now bids 2♠. By doubling first, then bidding his own suit, he shows a good suit and 17+ points.

SOUTH raises to 4♠.

West	North	East	South
		1♥	Pass
Pass	Dbl	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by North			

Board 4

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 4 2

♥ 5 3 2

♦ J 8 3

♣ J 7 4

♠ 8 7

♥ A 9 7 6

♦ A 6 2

♣ K 9 6 3



♠ T 6 5 3

♥ J T 4

♦ K T 9 5

♣ T 2

♠ A J 9

♥ K Q 8

♦ Q 7 4

♣ A Q 8 5

SOUTH has 18 points, a balanced hand, and a good stopper in their suit. He should overcall 1NT. For 1NT overcalls, the range is increased to 15-18 points.

NORTH bids 2♣ (Stayman), just as she would with a 1NT opening. When SOUTH denies holding a 4-card Major NORTH has enough points to bid 3NT. She doesn't worry about a ♠ stopper since SOUTH promised he had the suit controlled.

West	North	East	South
		1 ♠	1NT
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			